

AI Agents at Work

Classwork: Running a Real Agent

Name:

Date:

Today your group runs a REAL AI agent in opencode and puts it to work. You'll give it missions, watch the loop, interview it about how it works, run quick quests, and teach it a skill. Pick a Driver (shares screen and types) and switch the role each mission so everyone gets a turn!

Before You Start — Setup Check (about 5 min)

Follow the Setup Guide first. Tick these off as a group before Mission A.

1. opencode desktop app is open on the Driver's screen.
2. It's connected to OpenRouter with our class API key.
3. The model is set to DeepSeek V4 Flash.
4. You've made a new empty folder for the agent to work in.

RECAP

Remember: an agent is an LLM in a loop. It THINKS, calls a tool to ACT, SEES the result, and REPEATS until the job is done. Watch for those beats today!

Mission A — First Contact (about 8 min)

Give your agent its first real mission and watch it build something live.

1. In your empty folder, give the agent this mission:

Copy this prompt exactly:

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Make a webpage about our group's favorite animal. Include a title, 3 fun facts, and a colorful background. Save it as animal.html.
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2. Approve each step when the agent asks. Then open animal.html to see it.

What files did the agent create?

Did it work on the first try, or did you need to fix something?

CONCEPT

The agent didn't 'know' your webpage — it BUILT it, one tool call at a time. That's an agent acting in the world, not just chatting.

Mission B — Read the Loop (about 8 min)

Now slow down and watch HOW the agent thinks. Give it a job with multiple steps.

Copy this prompt exactly:

Create three files: math.html, science.html, and history.html, each with one quiz question. Then make an index.html that links to all three.

As the agent works, the group calls out each beat of the loop. Fill in 3 examples you saw:

THINK — something the agent decided to do:

ACT — a tool it called (Read, Write, Edit, Run...):

SEE — a result a tool gave back:

About how many tool calls did it take to finish the whole job?

Mission C — Interview Your Agent (about 10 min)

The best way to learn how an agent works is to ASK it! These are short questions, so they won't use much of our daily limit. Type each one and write down what the agent says in your own words.

Copy this prompt exactly:

In one short paragraph, explain how you remember things during our conversation. What happens to that memory when we start over?

In your own words, how does the agent's **MEMORY** work?

Copy this prompt exactly:

What is an MCP server, and how would adding one give you new abilities? Answer in 3 sentences.

What did the agent say an MCP server does?

Copy this prompt exactly:

What is a skill, and how is it different from an MCP server? Keep it short.

How did the agent explain the difference between a skill and an MCP server?

Copy this prompt exactly:

List the built-in tools you can use right now, with one short sentence each.

Which built-in tools did the agent list? Write any 3:

CONCEPT

Notice: the agent can describe its own tools and memory! That's because all of this was written into its instructions. Asking the agent is a real way developers learn a new tool.

Mission D — Quick Quests (about 12 min)

Short, fun missions to flex your agent. Do as many as you can — each one is small. Check the box when your group finishes it!

- ☐ Ask the agent to make a file called jokes.txt with 3 kid-friendly jokes inside.
- ☐ Ask it to write a 4-line poem about robots and save it as poem.txt.
- ☐ Ask it to make a tiny webpage with a button that says 'Click me!' and shows a surprise.
- ☐ Ask it to create a to-do list file with 5 fun things to do this weekend.
- ☐ Ask it to rename one of your files to something sillier.
- ☐ Ask it to count how many files are now in your folder and list them.

Which quest was your favorite, and what did the agent make?

Mission E — Teach It a Skill (about 12 min)

Write your own SKILL — saved instructions the agent follows your way, every time.

CONCEPT

A skill has 3 parts: a NAME, a DESCRIPTION (when to use it), and STEPS (what to do, in order). You're authoring the agent's behavior!

Skill NAME (example: story-maker, quiz-maker, joke-bot):

DESCRIPTION — when should the agent use this skill?

STEPS — list what the agent should do, in order (at least 3 steps):

1. Save your skill following the Setup Guide, then ask the agent to use it.

Did the agent follow your steps? What did it make?

Mission F — Group Build Challenge (about 12 min)

Teams compete! Use everything you've learned to build the coolest thing in the time given.

1. As a group, pick ONE build: a mini website, a text game, a themed quiz, or your own idea.

Plan your mission prompt **FIRST** (be specific — goal, features, finish line):

2. Give it to the agent, refine as needed, then share your screen with the class.

What did your team build?

What's one thing the agent did that surprised you?

Wrap-Up — Reflect (about 4 min)

What was your favorite part of running a real agent today? Why?

If you could give your agent ANY new superpower, what would it be and why?